

Spines to protect urchin

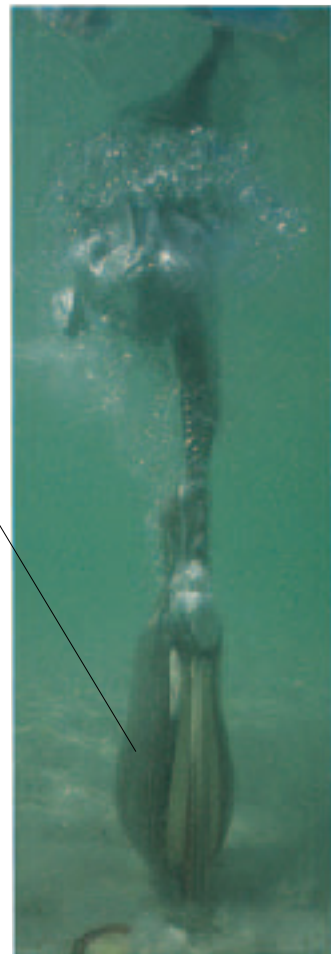
GRAZING AWAY

The European common sea urchin grazes on seaweeds and animals such as sea mats that grow on the surface of seaweeds. The urchin uses the rasping teeth on the underside of its shell that are operated by a complex set of jaws inside, known as Aristotle's lantern. The grazing activities of urchins can control how much seaweed grows in an area, so if too many urchins are collected for food or tourist souvenirs, a rocky reef can become overgrown by seaweed.



Pelican diving

Brown pelican catches fish in beak



FEEDING ON FISHES

Like all pelicans, the brown pelican has a big beak with a large flap of skin or pouch to capture a variety of fish. Once they have spotted their prey, they dive into the water, but are too bulky to dive too far below the surface. Only brown pelicans dive for their prey. When the pelican surfaces, water is drained from the pouch and the fish swallowed.

Tube-feet used to walk slowly along the seabed

Sea urchin's mouth surrounded by five rasping teeth

Tiny teeth of a basking shark

TO BITE OR NOT TO BITE

A tiger shark's tooth is like a multipurpose tool with a sharp point for piercing prey and a serrated bladelike edge for slicing. This shark can eat almost anything from hard-shelled turtles to soft-bodied seals and seabirds. The rows of a basking shark's tiny teeth are not used at all, since this shark filters food out of the water with a sieve of gill rakers.

Tiger shark's tooth

TENTACLE TRAPS

The flowerlike Dahlia anemones are deadly traps for unwary prawns and small fish that stray too close to their stinging tentacles. When the prey brushes past, hundreds of nematocysts (stinging cells) are triggered and fire their stings. These stings ensnare and weaken the prey. The tentacles pass the stricken prey toward the mouth in the anemone's centre—the entrance to the baglike stomach where the prey is digested.

Stinging tentacle

Any undigested pieces of food are ejected through the mouth

Suckerlike disk lets Dahlia anemone attach to any hard surface

